

Risk, Failure & Resilience

Why grit matters more than talent in entrepreneurship

Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____

Part 1 — Watch the Video First

Watch: **Grit: The Power of Passion and Perseverance — Angela Duckworth (TED)**

URL: youtube.com/watch?v=H14bBuluwB8 (6 min)

1. How does Angela Duckworth define 'grit'? Write her exact definition in your own words.
2. What evidence does she give that IQ and talent are NOT the best predictors of success?
3. What is a 'growth mindset' and how does it connect to grit?

Part 2 — Video Summary

Read this summary carefully — the quiz is based on these key ideas.

What grit actually is

- Angela Duckworth defines grit as 'passion and perseverance for very long-term goals.'
- Grit means treating life like a marathon, not a sprint — sticking with your future day in, day out, for years.
- It is not just working hard on something once — it is maintaining effort and interest over months and years despite failure.
- Grit is different from talent: talented people who quit are not gritty. Less talented people who never quit often outperform them.
- Duckworth studied West Point cadets, spelling bee champions, teachers in tough schools, and salespeople — in every group, grit predicted success better than IQ or talent.

Why this matters for entrepreneurs

- Entrepreneurship is one of the hardest paths someone can take — most businesses face serious setbacks before they succeed.
- The entrepreneurs who succeed are almost never the most talented or the smartest — they are usually the ones who refused to quit.
- Risk is unavoidable in entrepreneurship. The question is not whether you will face failure, but what you do when it happens.
- Resilience is the ability to recover from setbacks, adapt to change, and keep moving forward — it is a skill you can build.
- Every famous founder has a failure story: Apple nearly went bankrupt. Airbnb was rejected by investors 7 times. Oprah was fired from her first TV job.

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The growth mindset connection

- Duckworth references Carol Dweck's research on 'growth mindset' — the belief that your abilities can improve with effort.
- People with a growth mindset are more likely to be gritty, because they believe failure is not permanent.
- A fixed mindset ('I'm either talented or I'm not') leads people to give up when things get hard.
- A growth mindset ('I can improve with practice') leads people to keep trying and get better.
- You can deliberately build a growth mindset by reframing failure as feedback, not as evidence of inability.

How to build grit

- Find your 'why' — a purpose bigger than just making money makes it easier to keep going when things get hard.
- Embrace difficulty — deliberately choose challenging goals so you practice perseverance regularly.
- Learn from failure — every failed attempt teaches you something that brings you closer to success.
- Surround yourself with gritty people — mindsets are contagious; who you spend time with shapes your habits.

Part 3 — Key Vocabulary

Grit	Passion and perseverance toward long-term goals — the single best predictor of success in Angela Duckworth's research.
Resilience	The ability to recover from setbacks, adapt to failure, and continue moving forward.
Growth Mindset	The belief that your abilities and intelligence can be developed through effort, strategy, and learning.
Fixed Mindset	The belief that your talents and abilities are fixed at birth and cannot significantly improve.
Perseverance	Continuing to work toward a goal despite difficulty, failure, or slow progress.
Risk Tolerance	How comfortable you are with uncertainty and the possibility of losing something in pursuit of a goal.
Failure	An outcome that does not match your goal — and one of the most valuable teachers an entrepreneur has.
Passion	Deep, sustained interest in a pursuit — one of the two components of grit according to Duckworth.

Part 4 — Lesson Quiz

Circle the letter of the best answer for questions 1-4. Write your response for question 5 on the lines provided.

Do not look up the answers — complete this from memory after watching the video and reading the summary. Upload your completed sheet at futureceolab.com to see your score, which questions you got right, and the correct answers for any you missed.

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Q1. How does Angela Duckworth define grit in her TED talk?

- ☐ A Natural talent combined with hard work
- ☐ B Passion and perseverance for very long-term goals
- ☐ C The ability to stay calm under pressure
- ☐ D Intelligence combined with discipline

Q2. In Duckworth's research across many different groups (West Point, spelling bees, teaching), what did grit predict?

- ☐ A Who had the highest IQ scores
- ☐ B Who came from the most supportive families
- ☐ C Who was most likely to succeed and not quit
- ☐ D Who earned the most money

Q3. What is the key difference between a growth mindset and a fixed mindset?

- ☐ A Growth mindset people are naturally smarter
- ☐ B Fixed mindset people work harder
- ☐ C Growth mindset is the belief that abilities can improve with effort; fixed mindset believes talents are set at birth
- ☐ D There is no meaningful difference between the two

Q4. TRUE or FALSE: Talent and IQ are the best predictors of entrepreneurial success according to this lesson.

- ☐ A True — the most talented people always succeed in business
- ☐ B False — grit (passion and perseverance) is a better predictor than talent or IQ
- ☐ C True — you need to be naturally smart to be a good entrepreneur
- ☐ D False — luck is the only thing that matters

Short Answer — Question 5

Q5. Describe a time when you kept trying at something even after failing or struggling with it. What kept you going? What did that experience teach you about grit and resilience? If you cannot think of a personal example, describe how a famous entrepreneur you know of demonstrated grit.

Write your answer here:

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Reflection Journal (optional — not graded)

"On a scale of 1–10, how gritty are you right now? What is one area of your life where you give up too easily — and what would it look like to approach that with more grit?"

Write your reflection here:

How to get your grade: Take a clear, well-lit photo of this completed sheet — make sure every circled answer is easy to read. Go to futureceolab.com, open this lesson, and upload your photo. The site will scan your answers, show your score out of 5, mark each question green (correct) or red (incorrect), and reveal the right answer with an explanation for every question you missed. No answers are shown until after you submit.